



[Table of Contents](#)

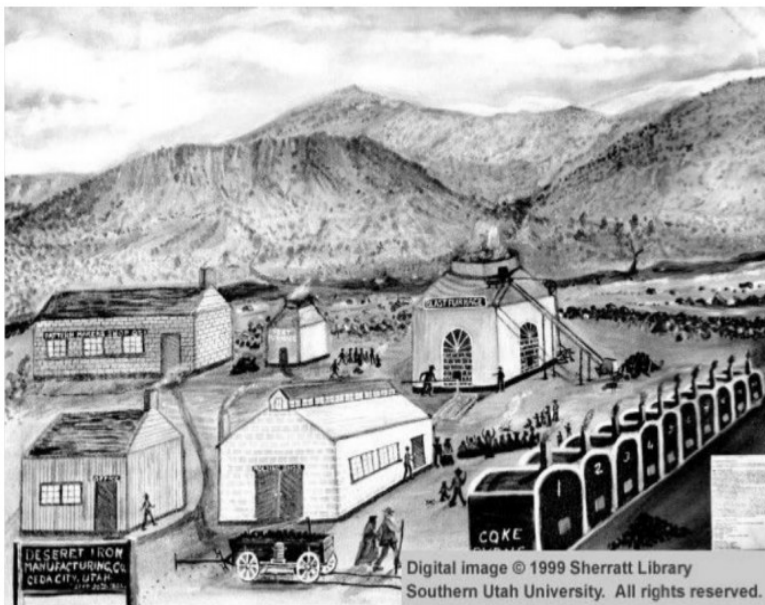
Henry Lunt Biography

(Scroll down for entire chapter)



[Chapter 8](#)

8. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 64.
9. Extracts from John Steel's Journal, *The Utah Historical Quarterly*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Utah Historical Society).
10. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 72.
11. *Ibid.*, p. 79.



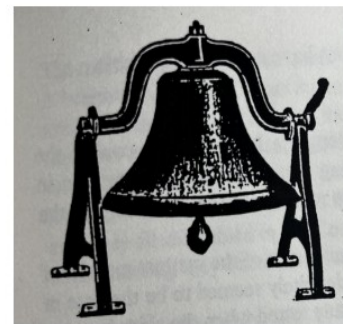
PAINTING OF IRON WORKS

Cedar City, Utah

Painted by R. D. Adams

Adams took his grandfather, Barclay Adams, an official at the Deseret Iron Company, to this spot on the banks of Coal Creek, First East and Fourth North.

With his grandfather's help, Adams painted this picture.



CHAPTER VII

TAPPING THE FURNACE

1852

Long hours of labor were devoted to the Iron Works by the brethren of Cedar City during the hot summer of 1852. The work consisted largely of building machinery for the blowing apparatus, erecting a blast furnace, mining stone coal, and making a road to the mine site. There were only about thirty five men in the colony, over half of whom were constantly employed in watering and taking care of the crops. On a number of occasions flood water gushed down Coal Creek and most of the brethren were required to help repair water ditches and replace the dam in the creek which washed out several times.¹ On July 16, 1852, Henry wrote in his journal:

I went up the canyon with nine men to finish working the road up to the coal. Tremendous thunder and lightning and heavy rain up the canyon. Rained down in the valley tremendous for about two hours commencing about 11 o'clock. The water was twelve inches deep in some of the houses and cellars in the Fort during the storm. Thanks be to God for such a delightful shower on this dry and thirsty land. Slept all night up in the canyon under some brush. The ground

Henry Lunt Biography

was very wet, and I did not have a very comfortable night's lodging.

The next morning Henry brought a load of stone coal to the blacksmith's shop where a meeting was held with the brethren in charge of iron, and some business was transacted pertaining to the rolling forth of the Iron Works.

History indicates that July can be one of the wettest months of the year in southern Utah, and that definitely seemed to be the case in 1852. The ditches and dams were truly tested when the skies became black nearly every afternoon and the rain soon followed. Up the canyon the constant downpour of rain filled the creek with logs, rubbish, and mud. Henry said, "the water was as thick as mush." As a result, the two dams dividing the stream between the field and the Fort were often entirely swept away and driftwood and debris clogged all the channels of all the ditches. It stormed every afternoon during the latter part of July which caused much damage. As a result, nearly every day Henry noted in his diary that, "another cloud seemingly has bursted on the mountains." A crew was organized each morning to clear the ditches and make new dams. The flood water varied in color from dark red to black or brown, depending on whether the storm was in the Cedar Breaks area or south in Right Hand Fork. Lunt described the water as, "sometimes being the color of soapsuds."

Henry wrote in his journal: "July 20, 1852: I labored on the Iron Works. I am this day 28 years of age. I thank the Lord, my Heavenly Father, that he has spared my life another twelve months and preserved me from all sickness and accident. I pray that He may continue to bless me with like blessings."

After the first company led by Brigham Young entered Salt Lake Valley on July 24, 1847, the settlers celebrated that day each year. In preparation for this event Henry and Ellen went with a number of brethren and sisters to Parowan on July 23, arriving at four o'clock p.m. A number of Parowan brethren rode out on horseback and in carriages to greet them. After a goodly amount of cheering, they escorted the Cedar City people into Parowan. There were two flags flying on the Liberty pole, the American flag and the Bishop's flag.

The motto, "Holiness to the Lord," was written on the Bishop's flag. A beehive and sheaf of wheat appeared under the writing, and a battle axe and spear were at the top of the flag. The group marched around the Fort and Brother George Brimhall assigned the visitors to stay with different families in the settlement. Henry and Ellen were located with Dr. Morse and his family. That night the trumpet blew and they all assembled in the Council House at six o'clock. After a short meeting they danced until midnight. Henry wrote:

Saturday, July 24, 1852: Celebration of the 5th anniversary of the 24th of July began at o'clock 5 a.m. The inhabitants of Parowan were aroused from their slumber by the roaring of artillery. At six o'clock the Battalion paraded on Artillery Square, under the command of Lt. Colonel James A. Little, and they fired a number of rounds of small arms. The whole of the people formed a procession on Artillery Square at one-half past eight, arranged in order by the Committee of Arrangements. The procession then marched to the house of President Smith and escorted him, John Steele, and myself [the Stake Presidency] to the Council House. As we joined the procession we took off our hats and gave three cheers accompanied by the whole of the people. We then marched into the Council House. The congregation was called to order by John D. Lee, Chairman of the Committee of Arrangements, and the choir sang, 'The Mountain Standard.' A beautiful and appropriate prayer was offered up by the Chaplain, E. F. Groves. The choir then sang 'Come, Come Ye Saints.' Brother Edson C. Whipple then delivered an oration appropriate for the occasion. J. C. L. Smith, John Steel, and myself each delivered a speech on the occasion, after which a number of toasts were read. Wm. Bateman and Richard Benson sang a song composed by John Steel for the iron mongers of Iron County. The meeting was dismissed.

Henry Lunt Biography

Henry and Ellen, along with the rest of the Stake Presidency, dined with the John D. Lees. At two o'clock the trumpet sounded again to gather the people together. There was dancing until midnight interspersed with singing, comic readings, and instrumental numbers. Henry wrote: "Excellent order prevailed throughout the day." After the closing song, the Presidency led the group in five cheers. "Hosannah to God and the Lamb forever. Amen."

When Lunt and Smith returned with their families to Cedar City the next day, they passed twelve Indian men and three squaws who were camped west of town. Henry rode back out to visit with them in their wickiup the following day and found them to be friendly, and he smoked the pipe of peace with the old chief. Later in the day Brother Shirts stopped by to see the Lunts. When Henry noticed Shirt's worn clothing, he gave him one of his best shirts and some salt.

It rained and flooded again and washed out both of the dams once more. On Friday, July 30, the bishop called the brethren together for the purpose of fixing the dams, but because the "iron men" did not go to help them, they would not work, making it necessary for everyone to pack water from the creek. During the Sunday meeting the brethren were invited to speak as they felt and many did, exhibiting a spirit of "jarring and contention." They decided to nominate some men to hold offices. Henry suggested the following: James Easton--Justice of the Peace; William Bateman--Constable, Alex Keir--Pound Keeper; James Bullock and Edward Williams--Fence Viewers; and Richard Harrison, James Bosnell and George Wood--School Trustees. After all hands turned out to fix the dams and water ditches on Monday, August 2, an election was held and these men were unanimously voted upon and duly took office.

Henry wrote the following entry in his journal on Wednesday, August 4, 1852:

Labored on the Iron Works. Brother John D. Lee came from Parowan and brought me a note from President Smith inviting the members of the High Council to be at Parowan on Saturday to attend a trial at one o'clock. In the evening Brother John White

and his two wives were before the Bishop for to settle difficulties as they could not agree together. After hearing considerable said on each side, I asked for the privilege of making a few remarks which was granted. I told the women and also Brother White that it was all a trick of the devil, and all these little faults arose from jealousy. I spoke on the principle of a man having more than one wife and his duty, and also the duty of the wives to their husband, and also to one another. The Lord blessed me with his holy spirit and caused the parties to see their error and to repent. Praise be the name of the Lord for his condescension and loving kindness to his Saints. Several of the brethren spoke afterwards and testified to the truths which had been spoken. The spirit of God was manifest and much good was done. The two sisters White took one another by the hand and kissed each other. May the Lord bless them and grant that they may keep His spirit with them. Amen.

The settlers were asked to fast on Thursday, August 5, after which a meeting was held. Henry made a few remarks and then invited the brethren to speak the way they felt. In the past Matthew Carruthers had been somewhat obstinate in following suggestions. For example, when the High Council advised the brethren against working on the Sabbath Day, Carruthers responded by ploughing his field on that day. Henry wrote the following in his journal:

Brother Carruthers spoke at considerable length and manifested a very bad spirit, finding fault with me and several other brethren.

We held a meeting in the afternoon and after I had spoke at some length, Brother Carruthers rose and acknowledged his faults and said he was sure that I had spoken by the good spirit and he felt satisfied to be in peace with all.

Henry Lunt Biography

It was moved and seconded by the brethren and carried unanimously that I be exempt from herding. It caused the flood gates of my heart to burst open with joy to my Heavenly Father for the good spirit that the brethren manifested.

Saturday, August 7, 1852: I rode horseback to Parowan. Brothers Carruthers, Chatterley, Harrison, and John Easton went with me in a buggy to attend another trial. Three men were involved in the case of Beason Lewis who had insulted the authorities. He did not make satisfactory acknowledgments and was disfellowshipped from the Church until he did. The President gave the others a heavy reproof and they were dismissed.

Commenced raining with heavy thunder and lightning about 3 o'clock and rained for three hours. The banks of the creek overflowed and both dams were washed away again. Was not very well in the evening. Slept at Dr. Morse's.

A Pihede Indian went into Brother Lee's house and was very impudent. Sister Lee took up a stick to drive him out and he immediately struck her with a club in the face and then on the head inflicting a very dangerous wound. Brother Barton, being near to the house, went to Sister Lee's assistance. He caught hold of the club just in the act of [the Indian] striking Sister Lee and prevented the blow. He then struck the savage twice with his fist and the savage ran away.

Monday, August 9, 1852: Counseled with Calvin Smith and John Steel and concluded to have the Indian whipped with forty lashes, tied to the Liberty Pole. We had the Pihede Chief and two more Indians in Brother Lee's house and gave the chief a very long conversation through Brother Lee's Indian boy who spoke English well and his mother tongue too. The old chief took it all first rate and said he would whip

the Indian himself at sundown. We told him, through the boy, a great many things about who their fathers were. The Indians worked with the settlers.

August 13, 1852: Labored for the Iron Works hauling loads of adobes, one load of fire clay and one load of red clay. Had two Indians working for me and one stayed with me all day, and a better workman I never did see as an Indian. He returned home with me in the evening and I gave him his supper. He washed his face clean and combed his hair. I invited him to come on the morrow and work for me and he said he would. Some of the brethren returned from the canyon yesterday and reported that they had found a fresh coal mine nearer than the other with thicker and better coal.

Henry referred to the Indian who worked daily with him at the Iron Works as "my Indian." When the wheat was harvested at the end of August, Henry wrote: "Cradled wheat for Brother Whittaker and 'my Indian' cleaned up. Brother Whittaker and James assisted me in cradling my wheat." Many of the Indians were converted.

Matthew Carruthers made the announcement to the brethren that he was leaving the settlement and moving to California. Henry wrote: "Friday, September 3: Made a trade with Brother Carruthers for his house and lot and 20 acres of land, garden and all its contents, a lot of corn, a lot of hay, a lot of lumber, and a lot of potatoes for two yoke of cattle." Two days later Carruthers came to Henry's house and asked if he could have his property back as he had changed his mind about going to California. Henry agreed to make the exchange.

Operating the Iron Works presented new problems almost daily. Henry was very disturbed about the progress and wrote the following in his journal:

Wednesday, September 8, 1852: The brethren seem to be much dissatisfied with Brother Harrison [Director of the Iron Works]. It is with great difficulty

Henry Lunt Biography

that Harrison can get any of the men to work under him. He has almost entirely lost the confidence of the Saints.

Sunday, September 12: Gave counsel to the brethren that the Iron Works had better stand still for a day or two until something would be done to affect a union amongst the brethren so that they could work together in consort. Five men united are better than fifty disunited.

The men of the settlement were making trips up the canyon to obtain coal in preparation for winter. Henry packed five bags of coal down the mountain on September 22, and hauled them to the Iron Works. He counseled the brethren on the subject of making iron before the upcoming L.D.S. Conference to be held in Salt Lake City. Some of the workers even worked all day on Sunday, September 26, in order to accomplish this goal. Henry wrote:

Wednesday, September 29: Commenced charging the furnace and put on the blast about noon. Labored most of the night. The machinery worked most excellent. [Coked stone coal and dry pitch pine wood in the raw state were used for fuel].

Thursday, Sept. 30: Tapped the furnace about six o'clock a.m. The metal ran out and all gave three hearty cheers. When the metal was cold, on examination, it was not found to be so good as might be wished and also of a very peculiar appearance. This was attributed to so much sulphur being in the stone coal. President J. C. L. Smith visited me in the evening and took supper with me--walked with him up to the Iron Works [The location of the Iron Works was at 400 North and 100 East]. Called a meeting in the evening. The brethren expressed their opinion on the trial of the iron ore and their faith seemed to be generally very good as regards to the quality of the

ore. I told them that President Brigham Young had sent for Brother Harrison and Brother Bladen.

October 1, 1852: Stormy day. Snow fell about two inches. Was obliged to stay in the house most of the day on account of my having no shoes or boots to wade in the snow and mud. I would here remark that I have suffered much for the last two years for the want of shoes and everyday clothing. I am thought worthy to suffer with the people of God.²

Brothers Harrison, Bladen, P. K. Smith, Cartwright, and George Wood started for Great Salt Lake City on October 1, 1852, to attend Conference.³ They took a sample of "pig iron" with them.

Henry sent the following letter to Salt Lake City on October 5, to be published in the *Deseret News* (it was published November 5):

President Richards: The weather has been very cold lately. October 1st--snowed nearly all day; left about two inches on the ground--very sharp frosts since. Our peaceful little settlement has been a little annoyed of late through California emigrants that have been passing. I was informed on Sunday evening that a small company of three men and two wagons had drove off a two-year-old colt belonging to Brother George Wood. I immediately called the brethren together and, after a few seconds consultation, six horsemen were soon on the track of the thieves. They returned the day following, after pursuing them for thirty miles. Brought back the colt and recovered 30 dollars for expenses (they paid with a watch valued at 25 dollars, and a five-dollar gold piece), very mercifully allowing them to wend their way to their Golden God. The prospects for manufacturing that all important article, iron, is excellent. I would that we had 500 good men at this time to develop the rich resources of this beautiful vale, and I am satisfied that

Henry Lunt Biography

iron to almost any amount could soon be manufactured. The machinery is of the best kind and works well and would do for a much larger furnace than what is up. In haste, I am yours, Henry Lunt.

The settlers harvested many loads of grass hay from the "meadow" which Henry claimed was the finest meadow he had ever seen in the mountains. It took almost an entire day to harvest a load of hay since the meadow was about six miles from the settlement.

A spark from Brother Keir's pipe started a fire in the meadow on October 18. The fire, fanned by a strong wind, spread rapidly. It appeared as though the entire crop would burn. There was a large stack of hay belonging to Brother Bosnell directly in the path of the flames as well as small stacks belonging to others. Henry wrote: "I fell on my knees and asked my Heavenly father to cause that the fire might stay its raging and destruction. By my exertions for about two hours I succeeded in putting the whole of it out." The next day Brother Bosnell visited Henry and said he was very much obliged to him for saving the hay, but he could not promise a reward for the trouble it took. That afternoon the fire started up again and burned Bosnell's stack of hay to the ground.⁴

The five men who went to Salt Lake City for conference returned on October 23. The day after they returned one of the men, Brother Bladen, examined the inside of the blast furnace and discovered a quantity of pure, malleable iron of a very superior quality in a solid lump weighing about 400 pounds. This discovery caused considerable excitement among the iron mongers. Henry's article in the *Deseret News* published on December 2, contained the following: "The greatest difficulty, in my opinion, is that the ore is so very rich that we are not acquainted with a system easy and simple enough to convert it into 'pig metal'."

The settlers were informed that Erastus Snow and Franklin D. Richards were on their way to Cedar City with another company of brethren from England to join the present men working at the Iron Works. Consequently, it was deemed wisdom to stop working until they arrived and another organization was formed.⁵ On Monday,

October 25, Bishop Lewis came from Parowan and reported that George A. Smith arrived there from Salt Lake City on Saturday, October 21. Henry made the following entries in his journal:

Tuesday, October 26: Rained heavy for several hours before daylight and the ground was white with snow which soon disappeared. I stayed in the house reading the *Deseret News* and cutting squash and pumpkins. I could not go out with any comfort as I have nothing but an old pair of moccasins for to put on my feet. I am now living with my father-in-law and am very thankful that I am so comfortable. Father Whittaker bought me two red flannel shirts from the store at Parowan and said I could pay him for them when I had the money and he would trust me until then.

Wednesday, October 27: George A. Smith, J. C. L. Smith, Bishop Lewis, W. H. Dame, and Father Gould came down from Parowan about 4 p.m. I was happy to see them. Went with Brother George A. Smith and the other brethren up to the Iron Works and to look out for a site for a city. Spent the evening in having a meeting in Brother Bosnell's house. Brother G. A. Smith preached a most excellent sermon. He requested that those brethren who intended to build this fall on the new city plot to give their names to me.

George A. Smith spent Thursday morning counseling with Henry. He appointed Henry and the Bishop to be in charge of giving out the new city lots.

The crops were very good that summer and Henry and Ellen, with the help of several Indians, spent many days harvesting the hay and vegetables. Henry paid the tithing on his crops on October 30. He wrote: "I had over thirty bushels of potatoes and paid four for tithing; had four bushels of turnips and paid one for tithing; 100 beets and paid ten of the largest which measured one bushel. Also, paid one

Henry Lunt Biography

dozen large carrots and one dozen large onions.” They also raised squash and pumpkins and an abundance of corn and grain. That day, after traveling to Parowan, Henry spent the evening in counsel with George A. Smith and President J. C. L. Smith. George A. Smith sealed Charles Dalton and Sarah Jane Lee for “time and all eternity” with Lunt and Smith as witnesses. Henry wrote: “It was a treat to me to be present, being the first time I ever saw the ceremony of sealing a woman to a man.” Partially as a result of this experience Henry and Ellen requested that they be sealed. This took place on November 14, 1852, when George A. Smith was in Cedar City.⁶

Henry and Ellen chose a corner lot in Cedar Fort, Plat A, Lot 5, Block 19. Henry wrote: “November 1, 1852: Took a walk and looked at the lot I had selected on the plot for the city. Found that it was rather broken having a hollow running through it and some large rocks on it. I was well satisfied with it knowing that no one would envy us of it, and they could not say that we had chosen one of the best lots.” Henry hauled many loads of adobes and rock in preparation to start building a home. Ellen and he were excited to get started on the foundation now that all the lots had been assigned.⁷

1. *Deseret Iron Company Minute Book*, October 1852 Entry, William R. Palmer collection, Special Collections Library, Southern Utah University, Cedar City, Ut.
2. Henry Lunt, “Henry Lunt Journal,” (Provo, Utah: B.Y.U. Library, copied from original journal, 1955), p, 103.
3. *Deseret Iron Company Minute Book*, *op. cit.*, p 1.
4. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 106.
5. *Deseret Iron Company Minute Book*, *op. cit.*, p. 2.
6. Lunt family file, “L.D.S. Family Group Sheet,” Marriage sheet of Henry Lunt and Ellen Whittaker, Verified sealing.
7. Henry Lunt, *op. cit.*, p. 111.